

Travel and Expense Policy

Company: Northstar Mobility

Category: Business Travel and Reimbursement

Policy Owner: Finance Operations

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Document Type: Employee-facing HR policy reference

Expense Rule	Standard
Book travel	At least 14 days ahead when the business schedule allows
Receipt threshold	25 USD
Expense deadline	10 business days
International travel	Director approval required

1. Purpose

This policy explains how employees plan business travel, spend company funds, and request reimbursement.

Employees are expected to spend responsibly, choose cost-effective options, and submit accurate expenses on time.

Managers approve expenses based on business purpose, policy compliance, receipts, and budget availability.

Employee guidance: keep related approvals, requests, receipts, or reports in the designated company system so decisions can be reviewed consistently.

Manager guidance: managers must apply this policy consistently, document exceptions, and consult the policy owner before approving any action that could create compliance, pay, privacy, security, or employee-relations risk.

Review standard: policy questions should be resolved using the current HR policy library, applicable law, and written guidance from the policy owner. Informal past practice does not override the approved policy.

2. Travel Approval

Overnight travel requires manager approval before booking. International travel also requires director approval and travel security review.

Travel must be booked through the approved travel platform unless Finance Operations grants an exception.

Employees book at least 14 days in advance when the business schedule allows it to reduce cost.

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Manager guidance: managers must apply this policy consistently, document exceptions, and consult the policy owner before approving any action that could create compliance, pay, privacy, security, or employee-relations risk.

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3. Air Travel

Economy class is required for flights under six hours. Premium economy may be approved for flights of six hours or more.

Business class requires vice president approval and is generally limited to flights exceeding ten hours or documented medical accommodation.

Employees may keep personal loyalty points when participation does not increase company cost.

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4. Lodging

Employees choose safe, business-appropriate hotels near the work location and within published city rate guidance.

Luxury hotels, suites, resort fees unrelated to business, and in-room entertainment are not reimbursable.

Employees use preferred hotels when available unless location, safety, or cost makes another option more reasonable.

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Manager guidance: managers must apply this policy consistently, document exceptions, and consult the policy owner before approving any action that could create compliance, pay, privacy, security, or employee-relations risk.

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5. Meals and Per Diem

Reasonable meals during business travel are reimbursable up to local daily guidance. Alcohol is reimbursable only with director approval and legitimate business purpose.

When meals are provided by a conference, hotel, airline, or host, employees must not claim a duplicate meal expense.

Tips must be reasonable and consistent with local customs.

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6. Ground Transportation

Employees use public transit, shuttle, rideshare, taxi, rental car, or personal vehicle based on cost, safety, and business need.

Rental cars require manager approval unless they are clearly less expensive than other options or necessary for the business itinerary.

Personal vehicle mileage is reimbursed at the published company mileage rate and requires route documentation.

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7. Reimbursable Expenses

Reimbursable expenses include approved transportation, lodging, business meals, conference fees, visa fees, required vaccinations, baggage fees, parking, and business communication charges.

Non-reimbursable expenses include commuting, fines, personal entertainment, gym fees, minibar charges, clothing, childcare, pet care, and optional upgrades.

Expenses must have a clear business purpose and be supported by receipts when required.

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8. Receipts and Submissions

Receipts are required for expenses of 25 USD or more unless local law or finance guidance sets a lower threshold.

Expense reports must be submitted within 10 business days after completing travel or incurring the expense.

Missing receipt affidavits may be used occasionally but repeated missing receipts may result in reimbursement delays or denial.

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9. Corporate Card Use

Corporate cards may be used only for authorized business expenses. Personal use is prohibited.

Employees must reconcile card charges by the monthly deadline and attach required receipts.

Lost cards, suspected fraud, or incorrect charges must be reported immediately to Finance Operations.

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10. Policy Exceptions

Exceptions require written approval from Finance Operations before the expense is incurred whenever possible.

Emergency exceptions may be approved after the fact when employee safety, travel disruption, or business continuity requires immediate action.

Managers may not approve their own expenses.

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Manager guidance: managers must apply this policy consistently, document exceptions, and consult the policy owner before approving any action that could create compliance, pay, privacy, security, or employee-relations risk.

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Acknowledgement and Questions

Employees are responsible for reading this policy and following the standards that apply to their role and location. Questions should be directed to the policy owner or People Operations before taking action when requirements are unclear.

This policy may be updated periodically. The current approved version in the HR policy library controls over printed or downloaded copies.